Your free community magazine about Thamesmead

thamesview

www.gallionsha.co.uk

May 06

Inside this issue



Thamesmead in bloom



Community Wardens



Tavy bridge

Thamesmead team clear up the canals



GALLIONS HOUSING ASSOCIATION

Editorial

Team Gallions have been busy maintaining the roundabout at Harrow Manor Way and those of you with an eye for colour will have seen the fantastic display of flowers on show. This spring over 3,000 plants were put in and today they are in full bloom. Over the coming few weeks Team Gallions will be replanting the roundabout with summer bedding which is currently being grown. It is sure to brighten up the area and bring enjoyment to many people. If you would like any advice about your own summer bedding why not give Tom Broad a call on 0800 83 84 81.

Complaints Contacts

Gallions aims to provide a first class service to all its residents. However, if you are unhappy with the service you have received there is a policy in place to help you make a complaint. A step-by-step guide is available on the Gallions website under the 'contact us' section. You may also get in touch with the Complaints Management team who will advise you what action to take. Your feedback is important to Gallions.

complaints@gallionsha.co.uk
www.gallionsha.co.uk
0800 83 84 81

Contents

3 Housing Update
Targeting flytippers

4/5 Community News
Thamesmead in Bloom

6 One to One Interview
Sgt. Noel Carmody

7 Thamesview Dozen
May Day madness

10 Events and clubs
Groups, clubs and activities

11 Financial News
Paying your rent

12 Competition Time
Try your luck

Team Gallions Meeting 10th May 2006

Team Gallions are holding a meeting on Wednesday 10th May at 7pm in the Tenants Resource Centre on Harrow Manor Way. It is an opportunity for residents to come along and discuss any concerns you may have regarding the cleaning and landscape maintenance services provided by Team Gallions. For more information please call 0800 83 84 81.

Customer Contacts Number

Gallions call centre is sometimes closed during office hours for staff training. To ensure your service continues as normal, all calls are automatically forwarded to Amicus, Gallions emergency repair service.

Thamesview Contacts

Reporters

Joy McKee
0208 320 3414

Emma Turner
0208 320 3552

E: thamesview@gallionsha.co.uk

Editorial Assistants

Joanne Scott

Caroline Wilson
0208 320 3409

ਜੇ ਅੰਗਰੇਜ਼ੀ ਤੁਹਾਡੀ ਪਹਿਲੀ ਭਾਸ਼ਾ ਨਹੀਂ, ਅਤੇ ਤੁਸੀਂ ਇਸ ਦਸਤਾਵੇਜ਼ ਦਾ ਤਰਜਮਾ ਚਾਹੁੰਦੇ ਹੋ, ਤਾਂ ਕਿਰਪਾ ਕਰਕੇ ਆਪਣੀ ਬੁਣੀ ਹੋਈ ਭਾਸ਼ਾ ਦੇ ਨਾਂ ਦੇ ਨੇੜੇ ਵਾਲੇ ਖ਼ਾਨੇ ਵਿਚ ਸਹੀ ਦਾ ਨਿਸ਼ਾਨ ਲਾ ਦੇ, ਅਤੇ ਫੇਰੀ ਹੋਈ ਥਾਂ 'ਤੇ ਆਪਣਾ ਨਾਂ ਅਤੇ ਪਤਾ ਲਿਖ ਦੇ ਇਹ ਫ਼ਾਰਮ ਕਿਸੇ ਲਿਫ਼ਾਫ਼ੇ ਵਿਚ ਪਾ ਕੇ ਹੇਠ ਲਿਖੇ ਪਤੇ 'ਤੇ ਭੇਜ ਦਿਓ।

如果英語不是您的母語，您希望將該文件翻譯出來的話，請在您選擇的語言旁邊打勾。請在所示之處填上您的姓名和地址，併用信封將本表格寄到下列地址。

Nếu Anh ngữ không phải là ngôn ngữ chính, Quý vị muốn dịch tài liệu này, xin vui lòng đánh dấu vào ô kế bên ngôn ngữ Quý vị chọn, ghi tên và địa chỉ vào nơi chỉ dẫn và gởi mẫu vào phòng bì theo địa chỉ đuổi dây.

Punjabi ○ Chinese ○ Vietnamese ○
(please tick one)

Name: _____

Address: _____

_____

_____

Return to: Joy McKee, Translation Requests, Gallions Housing Association, Harrow Manor Way, London SE2 9XH

Improving services

Having listened to your concerns about Gallions staff being more visible around Thamesmead, many of the association's tenant services are now being reviewed. Gallions is looking at ways to work more closely with you at a local level and to provide an improved out of hours service.

Over the next few months, Thamesview will be detailing how Gallions are moving forward with their plans. As they change the way they manage things, you will learn about staff in their new roles and will read about who to contact and where individual services can be found.

Have you got something to say about Gallions services? Then why not contact the Service Improvement Team on 0208 320 3425.

Important Gas Safety Checks

If you have received a letter from Gallions about a gas safety inspection, please do not ignore it. Gallions is legally required to check that your gas boiler is working properly every year. If you refuse to allow the contractor access to inspect your boiler, Gallions may be forced to take legal action.

If you have failed to make an appointment to have your boiler checked please get in touch with Gallions straight away. The inspection will only take about 30 minutes of your time and Gallions will be as flexible as possible in finding a time that suits you. These checks are vital and now is the best time to have them carried out.

If your boiler has not been checked please contact Carol Rayner 0208 320 3559 email crayner@gallionsha.co.uk

NEW COURSES AT RESOURCE CENTRE

This month sees the start of two new free courses at Gallions Tenants Resource Centre in Harrow Manor Way. Run by Bexley's Neighbourhood Learning, this is your opportunity to pick up some new skills.

Email and Internet

If you want to learn more about emailing and the internet well here's your chance. Bexley's Neighbourhood Learning is starting a four- week course to teach first time users how to get to grips with the internet and emailing. Many are a little frightened of the technology but this step-by-step course will give you the skills you need to get the most from the internet. Course starts on Wednesday 10th May 10am–12pm.

Aromatherapy

For those of you more interested in the natural things in life, there is also a free aromatherapy course. Here you will learn about the principles and the essential oils used in this alternative treatment. This four-week course starts on Thursday 11th May 10am –12pm.

For more information and to book your place please call Jas on 01322 552561.

Gallions and Greenwich target flytippers

Team Gallions spend more time and money clearing up dumped rubbish than on any other task. It is an enormous problem and one that affects everyone in Thamesmead. The London Borough of Greenwich issues fixed penalty fines to constant offenders. Since the beginning of the year Gallions has been working closely with the council to authorise some Gallions staff to take steps against flytippers. Tom Broad, Team Gallions Manager says, *"Gallions staff will be randomly searching through dumped rubbish bags. We will collect evidence and write letters to offenders asking them to dispose of their rubbish correctly. Those that continue to dump rubbish may be fined."*

Currently four Gallions staff have been trained and are now shadowing enforcement officers to help them get a feel for the task. Upon receipt of their warrant cards, they will be out and about in Thamesmead working hard to keep it rubbish free. Gallions is also working with the London Borough of Bexley to extend this scheme to its Bexley residents.

Broadwaters Surgery

If you live in the Broadwaters area why not come along to the Gallions surgery on 30th May at the Village Hall. Your housing co-ordinator will be on hand to discuss any issues or concerns you may have. A neighbourhood warden will also be there to advise you on what events and activities are planned for your area. For more information please call Jacqueline Degraft Johnson on 0800 83 84 81.

On your bike



Gallions Neighbourhood Wardens were put through their paces when they all received an intensive cycling course in March.

Covering basic training, safety and road skills as well as simple bike checks, the wardens all passed with flying colours. This means that all are now qualified to teach children aged from five years to nine years old how to ride a bike safely and to follow road safety rules.

Warden Bruce Bishop says. *"We will be taking the bikes out and about into local primary schools to teach the children how to cycle safely. Later in the year we hope to be able to offer this training to older children."*

Football's coming home

Charity football event

While the spotlight may be firmly focused on the opening game of this year's football World Cup in Germany, on 9th June Gallions will be playing the beautiful game a little closer to home. The association is fielding a team in a charity five-a -side competition in aid of the Demelza Hospice Care for Children. The venue is Charlton Training Ground and Thamesview has heard that the team is already in intensive training! Watch this space for news of how the team faired and final scores.

Broadwaters Ball Court League kicks off

Charlton Athletic Community Scheme and Gallions are running a series of coaching sessions and games at Broadwater Park (near Heronsgate Primary School). The sessions are open to boys and girls aged between 13 and 19 and are held every Thursday evening from 6.30 pm to 8.30 pm. **For more information please call Gallions Neighbourhood Wardens on 0208 310 2151.**

YOUR TAKE ON THAMESMEAD

Respond Community Matters provides support and services to the community. This month Community Development Manager Simon Platt shares his views with Thamesview.

What is your greatest fear?

That the problems faced on a daily basis by the existing community will be forgotten as new homes and people arrive in the area.

What is your greatest dream?

That the people who live here are treated with the respect that they deserve and have a community that could work together to deliver for them.

What would you like to see achieved in ten years time?

An improved infrastructure encompassing all aspects to improve the daily lives of the community. High on my list would be youth provision, health, housing, and safety.

How do you think this can be achieved?

By local councils, projects and residents working together towards one common goal. By encouraging true partnerships and lastly by not giving up and finding solutions not problems.

Cleaning up the canals





April 15th was the day when Gallions, Thamesmead residents and the environmental agency Thames 21 swung into action to clean up some of the local waterways. Gallions and Thames 21 have an on-going partnership where they regularly get together to haul rubbish from the canals.



Joined by a number of keen local environmentalists the group managed to pull nearly two tonnes of rubbish from the canal – in just one day! Thanks to everyone, particularly the residents, who turned up to help out. It is vital for wildlife and biodiversity that Thamesmead's famous waterways are kept clean and healthy. More 'clean up' days are in the pipeline and volunteers are always welcome.

For more information please contact Tom Broad on 0208 320 3497



Toy Library in Thamesmead

Linton Mead Primary School has come up with a novel way for children to enjoy a much wider range of toys. Every Friday morning during term time only the school runs a Toy Library in the Community Room between 9am and 11pm. It costs just £5 to join for a year (concessions are £2.50) with a small fee of between 10 pence and 75 pence for each toy borrowed. It's a great way for children to play with a whole host of new toys without costing mums and dads a fortune. **Please turn up at the community room for more information.**



Thamesmead in bloom

Whether a blooming balcony, a perfect patio or a gorgeous garden get your nominations in for this year's Thamesmead in Bloom competition. It doesn' t have to be your garden – it may be a neighbour's or you may have spotted a particularly pretty garden while out and about. All nominated gardens will be visited and prize winners can choose between garden or supermarket vouchers. There is also a prize available to those who take the time to nominate a garden. Entries must be in by Friday 23rd June.

If you are, or know of a talented gardener then why not fill in the application form below and return it to Irene George, Gallions Housing Association. Freepost SE691 SE2 9XH.
For more information please call 0800 83 84 81.

Category Front garden ☐ back garden ☐ balcony ☐ window box display ☐

Address of garden _____

_____

Name of gardener (if known) _____

Tel. Number of gardener (if known) _____

Name and address of person nominating garden _____

_____



ONE2ONE



Making the streets safer

The programme to establish a Safer Neighbourhood Team in every ward in London is being rolled out well ahead of schedule. Sergeant Noel Carmody, an officer with more than 30 years experience in the Met, heads up the Moorings newly launched team. Here he tells Thamesview how his team will work with the community to help tackle local problems.

For Sergeant Carmody one of the biggest changes to community policing over the years has been the lack of visibility. With officers spending much of their time today in cars, many people believe that there are simply not enough police out and about. Sergeant Carmody sees the Safer Neighbourhood initiative as an opportunity to put police officers back on the street and to make them more accessible to everyone in the community.

"The Safer Neighbourhood Team is about local policing to identify local issues. We want to tap into the grass roots knowledge and to draw up plans to target key problems. It is our overall aim to reduce crime in the area."

Sergeant Carmody is in the process of putting together a ward panel – a diverse group of 10 to 15 local residents who will work together to identify 3 key priority problems at any one time. While Sergeant Carmody or his deputy will attend the panel's meetings, it will be run independently from the police and will elect its own chairperson. Sergeant Carmody believes that this structure will allow residents to have greater control of their own neighbourhoods – something many have felt has been missing for too long.

"The ward panel will drive what problems we tackle. They will also be able to see with our problem solving processes what action we are taking to address their key concerns. The relationship between the panel and the team will be transparent and open."

Getting the right mix of people to sit on the panel is crucial to the success of the Safer Neighbourhood Team. Already the team are considering a number of people who have shown their commitment to the community over the years. Other possibilities for the panel are some of Gallions Neighbourhood wardens, local traders and youth workers. Sergeant Carmody is confident that together the panel and the police can make a real difference to crime and anti-social behaviour in the Moorings.

"The feedback from other Safer Neighbourhood Teams across London has been very positive. This approach to community policing is helping to restore people's trust and confidence in the police. And, as that continues to grow, we will be better placed to really tackle local problems."

For more information about the Safer Neighbourhood Team please send your queries to ThamesmeadMoorings.snt@met.police.uk or telephone 0208 284 9601.

Key Facts

- Each Safer Neighbourhood Team will comprise a minimum of one Sergeant, two Constables and three PCSOs
- Every area in the Greenwich borough is now covered by one of 17 Safer Neighbourhood Teams.
- There has been a fall of more than 5% in burglaries in Greenwich since November 2005
- The number of cars stolen in the borough of Greenwich has dropped by 25% over the last year and is below the London average.



PHONE MARKING

Having your mobile phone, personal stereo, iPod or similar items marked makes it harder for thieves to get rid of them. You can register your marked items for free with www.immobilise.com, a website linked to the Police Stolen Equipment National database. This will make sure that any recovered property is returned to its owner as quickly as possible.



May Day MADNESS

May Day is celebrated around the world. This month Thamesview takes a look at the history of this annual holiday and how it has been celebrated over the years.



1. The ancient Celtic May festival, Beltane or 'the fire of Bel', represented the first day of summer and was celebrated with bonfires to welcome in the new season.

2. In olden times young girls went into the fields very early in the morning and washed their faces with dew. They believed this made them very beautiful for the following year.



3. Traditionally May Day is marked with village folk dancing around the maypole and the selection of the May Queen.



4. Village gentlemen may be found celebrating with Jack-in-the-Green, otherwise found on the signs of pubs across the country called the Green Man.

5. It used to be customary for young men to wear new linen shirts on May Day, and their girlfriends would sew ribbons and bows on them. The men would then form a team, headed by the Garland Bearer, to dance on May Day.

6. Horses used to be decorated with ribbons, flowers and brasses on May Day and paraded through towns and villages.



7. May Day 1515 was celebrated by Henry VIII with a picnic on Shooters Hill!

8. In the sixteenth century riots followed when May Day celebrations were banned.



9. 'The Merry Monarch' Charles II helped ensure the support of his subjects by putting up a massive 40 metre high maypole in London's Strand.



10. May Day has now become a day of protest against capitalism around the world.



11. May weddings were once considered unlucky - yet it's one of the most popular times to get married.

12. The internationally recognised distress signal Mayday has nothing to do with May at all. Instead it is from the French phrase 'M'aidez', meaning 'Help Me'

WHAT'S ON AT TAVY BRIDGE

At the Tavy Bridge Project Office there are many FREE advice centres and groups that are there to help you. Along with information about the progress of the area's regeneration, there are a number of other meetings and sessions that may be of interest to you.

Welfare Benefits Advice

Gallions specialist advisor Derek Stainsby is on hand to make sure residents are receiving their full entitlement to housing benefits, social security benefits and tax credits.

He runs a session from the project office every 2nd Wednesday of each month from 10am until 4pm.

Neighbourhood Advice Sessions

Gallions Neighbourhood Warden's and Housing Co-Ordinators are available at the project office every Thursday afternoon from 3:30pm to 5pm to discuss any problems or concerns you have.

Employment Service

Trust Thamesmead's Building Futures project now runs a session every Tuesday from 10.00am to 12.30pm help you seek employment.

Legal Advice

Law Centre volunteers and trained welfare rights advisors will be available to discuss any queries you have or to give advice every Tuesday from 1.30pm to 3.30pm

There is no need to book to attend these meetings - just come along to the project office on the days and times that suit you.

Refurbishment starts at Tavy Bridge



The pace is really picking up at Tavy Bridge and this month sees the start of some major refurbishment work at Tilehurst Point and Blewbury House.

The communal areas and exterior of the blocks will enjoy a major overhaul while the flats themselves will see new doors, floors and kitchen units. Resident Involvement Officer Linda Harris says, *"Many residents have been inspired by the planned refurbishment and are saving to buy new items of furniture and to carry out further decorations to their homes themselves."*

Consultation has been central at every stage of the regeneration programme and the Tavy Bridge Regeneration Residents Action Group will be involved in choosing the final design of the new communal entrance areas of the blocks. Residents have already had the opportunity to select what colours and materials they would like used on the exterior of the blocks.

For the interiors of their own homes, residents have been able to choose such things as the design and colour of their new front entrance door; the colour of the tiling and floor covering in the bathroom; the colour and design of the kitchen units and work tops and the kitchen lay out. Linda says, *"It is great to see the work really beginning to start. Residents have waited patiently and worked with us to make this happen and now it is all beginning to take shape."*



meet the team

Transforming Tavy Bridge

The regeneration of Tavy Bridge will make an enormous difference to the whole of Thamesmead. This month Thamesview talks to Gallions Regeneration Team. They are working hard to make sure residents are involved at every step of the way as the new look Tavy Bridge begins to take shape.





Kenneditta (Kenne) Amissah

Regeneration Manager
kamissah@gallionsha.co.uk

Role in The Association

Kenne is responsible for developing partnerships, identifying regeneration opportunities and for seeking out funding to support the association's growth and regeneration plans. Kenne aims to establish Gallions as a key player in the Thames Gateway area and beyond.

Kenne is advising Gallions where their next regeneration project should be. Currently, she is drawing up a plan to make sure that all the necessary funding and resources are in place as Gallions looks towards the next regeneration opportunity.

"The Tavy Bridge team brings together a wide range of experience, skills and local knowledge that really works to the benefit of the residents. Our dedicated project office is a central point where residents can drop in and discuss any issues they may have. Working so closely with the residents the team is able to tap in straight away to any concerns or problems they may have and to provide timely and effective solutions. This 'front line' service helps underpin many of our decisions."

Debbie Withall

Regeneration Project Manager
dwithall@gallionsha.co.uk

Role in The Association

Debbie's role is to oversee the delivery of regeneration projects and is currently managing Tavy Bridge. She is actively involved in all areas of the project and works closely with Wates and other key stakeholders to make sure both Gallions and residents receive the best deal possible from the regeneration scheme.

Debbie is responsible for ensuring the many different aspects of Tavy Bridge all run smoothly together and that all necessary parties are engaged in the process. Debbie also helps to set up new projects and to prepare funding applications to support Gallions work.

Linda Nash

Regeneration Project Officer
lnash@gallionsha.co.uk

Role in The Association

Linda helps identify local needs and maps out local services. As part of her role, Linda builds and maintains relationships with external partners and stakeholders to create as many opportunities as possible for Tavy Bridge.

She works in the project office alongside Linda Harris and has helped set up a number of surgeries including Benefits and Banking, Legal Advice, Education and Training. Linda is also working closely with Bexley Care Trust and other partners in the development of a Sexual Health Clinic on Tavy Bridge.

Linda Harris

Resident Liaison Officer
lharris@gallionsha.co.uk
(pictured)

Role in The Association

In her role Linda works directly with the residents of Tavy Bridge and is responsible for delivering clear and consistent communication.

She works at the Project Office on Tavy Bridge every Tuesday and Thursday, offering help and advice to whoever comes in.

Having set up the Tavy Bridge Residents Group, resident meetings and visits to other regeneration schemes are regularly organised and well attended. Linda also helps with the decanting of residents, making sure that the move is as smooth as possible.

Caroline Thackeray

Regeneration Project Co-ordinator
cthackeray@gallionsha.co.uk

Role in The Association

Caroline's role is to support the team and coordinate all aspects of the Tavy Bridge project.

She works at the Project Office when needed and gets involved with resident meetings and visits. She helps organise residents events and deals with resident enquiries.

Caroline also assists in the day to day running of the team, producing and assisting with reports and spreadsheets and also dealing with leaseholder buybacks, decants and any other enquiries that arise.

Stay active this summer with our clubs and groups

Young People

Cave Climbing Wall
Thamesmead's climbing wall is an excellent way to learn a new skill or to improve on your climbing technique. **www.trust-thamesmeadcave.co.uk**
Tel: 0208 320 4494

Fun Club
Glimpsing Green
Saturday morning fun for children up to 11 who have a disability or a special need.
Tel: 020 8311 6777

Brownies
Church of the Cross,
Lensbury Way
Girls aged 7 to 11
Tel: 0208 310 2419

Guides
Church of the Cross,
Lensbury Way
Girls aged 11+
Tel: 0208 310 2419

Greenmeade Community Hall
- *Carer & Child Drop-in*
- *Sunshine Club for children with autism*

Tel: 0208 303 1006

Rainbows
Arnott Close Club Room
girls aged 5 to 11 years

Brownies
Arnott Close Club Room
girls aged 7 to 11 years
Tel: 0208 244 3488
07958 967902
e. sandy.white70
@ntlworld.com

New Acres Library Tavy Bridge
Tel: 020 8311 5291

- *Baby Time*
  Nursery rhymes, singing, stories for the under 4's and their parents.
- *Family Learning*
  For children 5 + years and their parents.
- *Story Time*
  For children 3 to 5 years and their parents.
- *Teenage Reading Group*
  Fun activities to help teenagers discover books.

Music and Dance

Myztikal
Church of the Cross Hall
Lensbury Way
Street dance classes
ages 8 to 15
Tel: 07956 949249

Theatre Street
Broadwater Village Hall
Gooseander Way
Dancing, singing and drama
Tel: 01322 441977
Web: www.theatrestreet.com

Youth Advisory Project
Gallions Housing Association
Harrow Manor Way
Music for 16 to 24 years old
Tel: 020 8311 5111

Clubs and Groups for the Elderly

Over 50's Bingo Club
Greenmeade Community Hall
Monday and Thursday
7.30 to 9pm
Tel: 0208 303 1006

Pop-In Parlour
Evenlode House
Coralline Walk
Tel: 020 8310 7437

Teeswater Atrium
Variety of groups and activities 7 days a week Including Bingo, darts, sewing, ballroom and line dancing and an African social group.
Tel: 0800 83 084 81

After School Clubs

Birchmere Club
Near *Disraeli Close*
Tel: 020 8311 8886

Hawksmoor Youth Club
Bentham Road
Tel: 020 8312 4022

Heronsgate Club
Whinchat Road
Tel: 07950612826

Playgroups

Goose-e-ganders
Parent and Toddler group.
Tel: 07958 640645

Toddles
Manor Close Community Hall
Manor Close
Tel: 020 8310 9004

Toddles with Tavy Bridge Pre-School
Senior Citizens Hall,
Tavy Bridge
Tel: 07950 853481

To list your group please contact Joy Mckee on 0208 320 3414

What time is it? Trust Thamesmead Summer Festival time

Last year saw Liberty X, Alexander O'Neil, Javine and others performing on the main stage at Trust Thamesmead's first ever Summer Festival. This year's event is set to be even bigger and better, with lots more celebrities, (let's just say you won't be feeling blue when you leave Birchmere Park), our very own T- Factor winners, competitions, stalls, fun-fair and lots of family activities. It's going to be a day to remember, so write it in your diary now.

Trust Thamesmead Summer Festival, Saturday 15 July, Birchmere Park.

To keep up to date with the latest Summer Festival announcements visit www.trust-thamesmead.co.uk



An up-to-date list of where and how you can pay your rent in and around Thamesmead

Local Payment Outlets

Outlet	Address	Phone Number	Payment
Costcutter	7-9 Arnott Close SE28	020 8310 9731	cash only
Gunis Supermarket Ltd	4 Whinchat Road SE28	020 8317 7600	cash only
Londis	100a Harrow Manor Way SE2	020 8311 4427	cash only
Londis	39 Manor Close SE28		cash only
Londis	17 Wilton Road SE2	020 8311 4733	cash only
Costcutter	10 Tavy Bridge SE2	020 8312 3593	cash and cheques
HA Patel	172 Eynsham Drive SE2	020 8310 4516	cash only
Abbey Wood Post Office	105 Abbey Wood Road SE2	020 8311 2798	debit card, cash & cheques
Eynsham Post Office	166 Eynsham Drivce SE2	020 8310 7054	debit card cash & cheques
Arnott Close Post Office	6 Arnott Close SE28	020 8310 9505	debit card, cash & cheques
Lime Stone Walk Post Office	Lime Row DA18	020 8311 4330	debit card, cash & cheques

DO IT WITH DIRECT Debit

Whether you want to pay your rent weekly or monthly, now paying by direct debit couldn't be easier. If you fill in a direct debit form and return it to Gallions, your rent will automatically be paid on a set date every week or month.

You won't have to set out for the post office or shop every week and your payment is covered by the Direct Debit Guarantee. What this means is that if Allpay, the collection company used by Gallions, makes an error, you are guaranteed a full and immediate refund to your bank account. If you do decide to switch to payment by direct debit and are not happy with it, you can cancel it by simply writing to your bank or building society. So far some 350 residents are paying their rent by direct debit - so what are you waiting for?

For more information about how to set up a Direct Debit from your bank account please call into Gallions Harrow Manor Way offices and ask for a Direct Debit application form.

You may also call freephone 0800 83 84 81

- **A simple, hassle-free way to pay your rent every week or month.**
- **One form covers any changes up or down to your rent.**
- **Protected by a guarantee of a refund if mistake is made.**

DEALING WITH DEBT

Is debt becoming a problem for you?

Are you having trouble meeting your financial commitments? Then why not get in touch with Gallions Debt Helpline. Specialist advisers will be in touch to discuss your options.

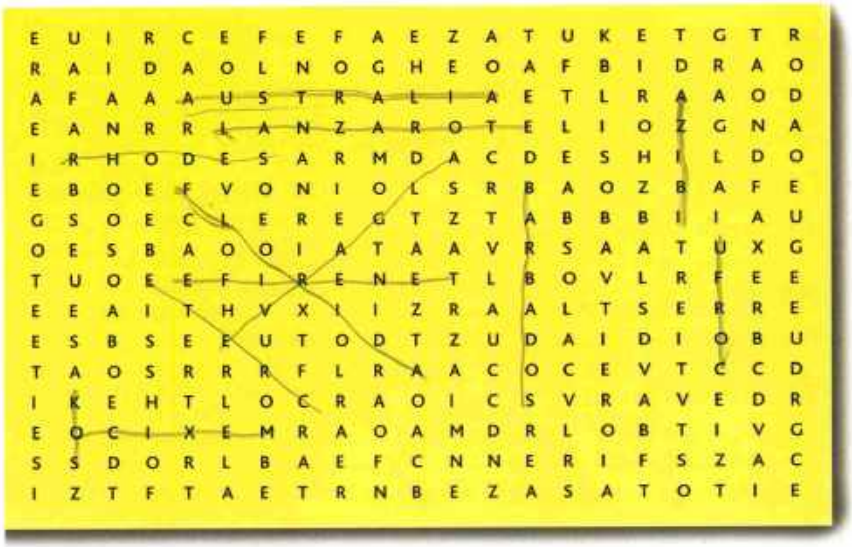
DEBT HELPLINE
0208 320 3687

DEAL WITH DEBT, DON'T IGNORE IT.

TAKE A BREAK

Why not try your luck at this month's word search. Sit back, relax and spend some time dreaming of the long summer evenings ahead. The lucky winner will collect £25 worth of WHSmith vouchers.

IBIZA
AUSTRALIA
RHODES
LANZAROTE
TENERIFE
ALGARVE
FLORIDA
CORFU
KOS
BARBADOS
MEXICO
CRETE



Name

Address

Telephone

Just send in your correctly completed word search to the address below, along with your name and address, by Monday 22nd May. The winner's name will be pulled out of a hat. Word Search Competition, FAO Marie Dunster, Gallions Housing Association, Harrow Manor Way, London, SE2 9XH or drop the entry into Gallions reception.

LOCAL Listings

Chemists

Whinchat Chemist
1 Whinchat Road,
Tel: 0208 333 5000

A F Browne Chemist
4 Tavy Bridge
Tel: 0208 310 7209

Churches

Christian Life Centre
11 Arnott Close
Tel: 020 8310 5361

St Paul's Ecumenical Church
Bentham Road,
Tel: 020 8310 6814

Titmuss Avenue Baptist Church
85 Titmuss Avenue
Tel: 020 8310 1683

Power Light Evangelism
2c Goosander Way
Tel: 0208 310 9149
powerlightevang@aol.com

Open Gateway United Church
62-64 Battery Road
Tel 0208 836 9069

Dentists

Gallions Reach Dental Anaesthetic Clinic

Heronsgate Dental Centre
1b Gooseander Way
Tel: 020 8316 6313

Vijay Vithani
12 Joyce Dawson Way
Tel: 020 8311 9400

Lakeside Dental Practice
69 Tavy Bridge
Tel: 0844 4778966

Doctors

Heronsgate Medical Centre
1a Gooseander Way
Tel: 020 8333 5050

Gallions Reach Health Centre
Bentham Road
Tel: 020 8333 5000

Lakeside Health Centre
Tavy Bridge
Tel: 0208 8310 3045

Hospitals

Queen Elizabeth Hospital
Stadium Road, Woolwich
Tel: 020 8836 6000

Queen Mary's Hospital
Frognal Avenue, Sidcup
Tel: 020 8302 2678

Transport

National Rail Enquiries
Tel: 08457 484950

London Travel Information
Tel: 020 7222 1234

Hear this

Erith and Thamesmead MP John Austin is backing the Breaking the Sound Barrier campaign. The campaign aims to change people's attitudes to hearing loss and hearing aids.

The Royal National Institute for the Deaf is offering a five-minute telephone hearing check for those with problems. John Austin says, "*I would certainly recommend it for anyone over 50 who thinks they are having difficulty hearing conversations.*" **For your free hearing check call 0845 600 55 55.**

Hats off to the team

Gallions West Thamesmead Patch team would like to thank everybody who supported the Easter Bonnet Parade in April. It was well attended by local residents who all enjoyed an afternoon of tea and karaoke. Prizes were donated by the Princess Alice and Snippers Hairdressers on Battery Road, while students from the floristry course in the Community Centre made the bonnets.

If undelivered please return to:
Gallions Housing Association,
Harrow Manor Way, London SE2 9XH